Teachers were told who would "bloom."

> The names were picked at random.

Oak School, South San Francisco.

> Every child took a test billed as a predictor of "intellectual blooming."

About 1 in 5 kids were named bloomers.

1 in 5

students labeled "bloomers", chosen at random

Bloomers gained about 12 IQ points.

"BLOOMERS"

≈ +12 points

EVERYONE ELSE

≈ +8 points

Most of the gap: 1st and 2nd graders.

"So defective technically"

Robert Thorndike's verdict on the study.

Real flaws in the data.

1. Some IQ scores implausibly low
2. Test may not suit young kids
3. Teachers barely remembered the list

Real, but usually small.

> Strongest when teachers barely know the students yet.

YOUR MOVE

Check your expectations before they become someone's ceiling.

1. What do I expect from them?
2. What is that based on?
3. What would prove me wrong?